Sara Barthel de Weydenthal

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Education

University of Washington — Seattle, WA
B.A. Mathematics, Economics (Double Major) GPA: 3.5/4.0 — *Sep 2023 – Dec 2026*

Experience

Co-Founder & CEO — Feb 2025 – Present
Posy Social Inc. [App] [Demo] — *Seattle, WA*

- Co-founded and developed a consumer tech product end-to-end: wrote the product specification for every feature and user flow, maintained the backlog, ran sprint planning and reviews, and worked directly with my co-founder to ship a three-tier app (React Native, Firebase, Python) built on a proprietary compatibility algorithm adapted from original graph-theory research.
- Ran the user research that set the roadmap: a 35-user survey and a two-month closed beta, wireframing and prototyping features in Figma and Claude Code before committing engineering time, growing the product from 0 to 220+ users and 50 matches at the University of Washington and top 10% in Y Combinator Fall 2026 applications batch; featured in *The Daily* [Article].
- Led internal growth tooling: scoped and shipped a full-stack media outreach system (Next.js, TypeScript, Prisma) from written requirements, directing Claude Code and self-verifying through live API endpoint tests.

Product Strategy Summer Analyst — Jun 2026 – Aug 2026
PIMCO — *Newport Beach, CA*

- Built a competitive analysis benchmarking PIMCO's global funds against peer products in Bloomberg and PowerBI to evaluate the business case for launching a new ETF, then presented the go/no-go recommendation to senior stakeholders.
- Authored the team's AI strategy roadmap on Microsoft Copilot, writing an internal guide on prompt engineering, context windows, and output evaluation, and outlining PRDs for AI-assisted workflows.

Venture Capital Fellow — Jun 2025 - Jul 2025
Dorm Room Fund — *Remote*

- Sourced and evaluated student-led startups, assessing product, market, and founding teams.

Summer Analyst — Jun 2025 – Aug 2025
Goldman Sachs — *New York, NY*

- Built time-series models in MS Excel on deposit betas and customer liquidity behavior, then stress-tested credit risk scenarios across liquidity, credit, and operational exposure in Transaction Banking, translating results into written recommendations for cross-functional teams.

Junior Data Operations Engineer — Jun 2022 – Aug 2022
Crystal Equation (Meta) — *Warsaw, Poland*

- Built Python data pipelines and wrote SQL queries in Presto to access and analyze data across multiple sources, automating internal analytics workflows for global product teams, and debugged Hacklang backend exceptions alongside engineers.

Projects & Additional Experience

- **Coding Instructor & Curriculum Developer, Kids Code Fun / Girls Code Fun** (Jan 2018 – Jun 2021): Taught weekly coding classes to students ages 8–16, designing an HTML/CSS/JavaScript curriculum for beginners and a React Native track for advanced students.
- **Product Manager & Engineer, Web Impact UW** (Jan 2024 – Jul 2024): Led a 5-person team building a full-stack educational web app (React, Firebase) from ideation to deployment, owning the roadmap, specs, and Agile sprints.
- **Quantum Computing Research Scholar, PhysicsBeyond** [GitHub] (Apr 2024 – Jun 2024): Designed and benchmarked quantum neural networks in PennyLane and TensorFlow on IBM quantum hardware for sales forecasting, improving predictive accuracy by 15% over classical ML baselines (MSE, R^2).
- **Mathematics Researcher, UW Department of Mathematics** [Paper] (Jan 2024 – Mar 2024): Modeled matchmaking with graph theory and probabilistic simulation in Python; the basis for Posy's engine.
- **Founder & President, UW CareerWomin**: grew the organization from zero to 149+ members in 6 months.

Skills

- **Product**: PRDs, roadmapping, Agile sprints, UX research, prototyping, A/B testing, funnel analysis, go-to-market.
- **Technical**: Python, SQL (Presto), TypeScript, React Native, Next.js, Prisma, Firebase, PennyLane, Claude Code, Figma, Google Analytics, PowerBI, Bloomberg, TensorFlow.